strenuous efforts, and that too may not help derive the complete value from the data.

They are not designed for change

As mentioned before, in relational databases data is arranged in columns and rows-with each row having a unique entry and every column attributing unique value to the entry. This being the case, the data modeling has to be done in advance and sometimes this could mean months or even years, the duration dependent on the system.

Once the modeling is done, to bring in significant changes in the structure is again a time and resource consuming endeavour. Big data, by default is consistently appended, or the values may keep changing for some of the parameters. This demands a high level of flexibility from the database. Something, the relational structure obviously isn't suited for.

THE JOY OF WINNING ELECTIONS WITH BIG DATA

India's current ruling party led by Prime Minister Narendra Modi had effectively used Big Data analytics in 2014 to fetch the taste and interests of people living in various parts of the country. This enabled them to identify potential issues from over 800 million voters and find remedial solutions.

For scalability,elasticity and resilience, relational databases are far from the best

Scaling up databases is an inevitability for many organizations if they are to keep functioning. This scenario spurred by an overwhelming rise in the volume of data has been noted by relational database vendors. And to address the problem they have devised such 'solutions' as in-memory processing, better use of replicas and distributed caching, even shared storage. In the right place though their heart may be, these re-engineering ideas from the vendor won't suffice to scale up relational databases to the desired levels. And more often than not, the only thing that's resulted from forcing a scale-up is accumulation of more expensive hardware without gaining any significant advantage.